



One doesn't even need to be told how popular Github is

Remember the axe-murderer when writing commit messages

There's an old adage that says :“Write every commit message like the next person who reads it is an axe-wielding maniac who knows where you live”. If I was that maniac and I'm delving through reams of your code trying to track down a bug and all I can understand from your commit message is “updated some codes”, I will find you.

The whole point of commit messages is to explain why you committed the code. Maybe something was broken in the jdbc pool. Maybe the customer didn't like the layout of the page. Maybe you're just tweaking the build configuration to optimise performance. Whatever it is, there's a reason for it and you need to log this in while committing the code.

Nothing but code belongs in source control

A easy way to say this would be: “Nothing that is automatically generated as a result of building your project should be in source control.” It may break things as your local settings , credentials etc might get overwritten on all other peoples machines and this will not work until they revert those changes back and then recompile. And then once they do recompile and recommit, they start sending the files in opposite direction and this time you're the one who has the problem.

Dependencies need a home too

This might be the last of the guidelines but it's a really, really impor-